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UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED RECEIVES UZBEKISTAN PRESIDENT'S HEAD OF ADMINISTRATION

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan on Saturday received Saida Mirziyoyeva, Head of the Administration of the President of Uzbekistan. During the meeting, Mirziyoyeva conveyed the greetings of Uzbekistan's President, Shavkat Mirziyoyev, and his best wishes for the UAE's continued progress and prosperity. Opportunities to further strengthen bilateral cooperation in support of the two countries' development ambitions and the wellbeing of their peoples were discussed in the meeting.

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TRUMP SEES WAR ENDING SOON; UAE CALLS FOR LASTING PEACE

Iran holds firm on Hormuz as 5 face UK terror probe

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump said yesterday that the Iran war could end soon and predicted oil prices would fall sharply once the conflict was over, pointing to increased crude flows through the Strait of Hormuz.

"Oil is going to come plummeting down and oil prices are coming down," Trump told reporters, claiming a record amount of oil had moved through Hormuz overnight, exceeding volumes before the war.

Trump yesterday told Axios he expects further talks with Iran this week, despite rejecting Tehran's proposal to end the war. Regional sources said another round of indirect negotiations could take place as early as today, with Qatar continuing mediation.

Gargash: Not just a pause

Meanwhile, the UAE has stressed that any agreement must produce lasting peace rather

than simply pause the fighting. "We do need peace, but I think also we need peace that will last," Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, told *Foreign Affairs*. "We don't need... a patch-up job where suddenly within three months, four months, five months, we have another outbreak."

Gargash called for substantive talks between Iran and its Gulf neighbours alongside negotiations involving Washington, saying any settlement needed greater permanence.

Not backing down

Iran, meanwhile, stood firm on its conditions for reopening Hormuz despite Trump's rejection of its proposal.

Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said Tehran would "not back down" from its demands and was still awaiting Washington's formal response through mediators.

Iranian forces also said they had struck 19 vessels over the previous two nights after accusing them of attempting to use unauthorised routes through Hormuz.

Oman reaffirmed its commitment to safeguarding navigation through the strait and urged all parties to cooperate with Muscat's efforts.

Iran's military separately said it remained prepared for further US action, with army spokesman Brigadier-General Mohammad Akraminia describing Washington's regional position as "precarious".

In Britain, five men were arrested on suspicion of preparing a terrorist act after three suspicious vehicles were found near RAF Fairford, a base used by the US Air Force and previously used for strikes on Iran. Counter-terrorism police are investigating, but have announced no motive or link to Iran.

Bessent thanks the UAE

US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, meanwhile, thanked the UAE, Oman, Turkey and Britain for supporting Washington's economic pressure campaign against Tehran under "Operation Economic Outcast".

SEE ALSO P6, 7, P-IV

THE LIGHTS ARE ON IN
HELSINKI

FLY BETTER

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